

Jacques Quass de Vos

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About me

Economist with 3+ years in government, research, and data analytics; currently completing a Master of Economics (graduating March 2027) focused on theoretical and empirical economics. Combines applied research and causal inference with production-grade data engineering. Particular interest in trade, spatial economics, and geopolitics.

Education

The University of Osaka

Master of Economics, Sustainable Economy Program

Osaka, Japan

April 2024 – March 2027

- Intensive academic training in a highly selective 6-student international programme.
- Core coursework: macroeconomics, microeconomics, econometrics, international trade, labour economics, urban economics, public finance, media agenda-setting, applied econometrics, and econometric analysis.
- Research: (1) TICAD and Japanese FDI in Africa; (2) endogenous trade costs and the Suez Canal disruption.

Stellenbosch University

Bachelor of Commerce in International Business

Stellenbosch, South Africa

Feb. 2019 – March 2023

- Competitive four-year degree preparing students for careers in international business and consulting.
- Key modules: economics, statistics, financial management, investment management, urban economics, machine learning, politics, philosophy, global history, African economic history.
- Six-month exchange semester to Waseda University, School of Political Science and Economics in Tokyo.

Professional Experience

Associate Analyst (Data Scientist)

Codera Analytics

Remote

Aug. 2024 – present

- Notable project: Scraped and processed nearly 1 million news articles from five major South African newspapers (2010–present), creating a rich textual dataset for economic sentiment analysis.
- Author policy papers and op-eds for publication under Codera's research imprint.
- Design and maintain automated ETL pipelines in R/Python for Codera's EconData platform, processing international economic indicators, trade, and news data from ingestion through to visualisation.
- Lead custom research and analysis for clients in domains like international trade and African public finance.
- Publish regular data stories that drive client engagement and inbound interest.

Junior Economist (Research, Policy and Planning)

Western Cape Government, Department of Economic Development and Tourism

Cape Town, South Africa

July 2023 – April 2024

- Managed and co-authored economic update reports, strategic documents, and bespoke research projects; identified inefficient policies and proposed evidence-based alternatives adopted by stakeholders.
- Drafted parliamentary responses for the Provincial Minister of Finance and the Western Cape Premier.
- Delivered weekly macroeconomic briefings to senior departmental officials and external stakeholders.
- Co-authored Economic Impact Analysis of the Province's SMME Booster Fund during the COVID-19 pandemic—a high-profile report assessing emergency support to small businesses.
- Conducted rapid-response analyses including: tourism and film industry performance, restaurant sector trends, taxi strike impacts, and the anticipated costs of Europe's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism.
- Received the highest possible rating on annual performance review.

Research Assistant

Stellenbosch University Japan Centre (SUJC)

Stellenbosch, South Africa

April 2023 – April 2024

- Supported major collaborative research projects and represented the Centre at international seminars.
- Published independent research pieces and played a key role in developing the SUJC website.

Additional Experience

Travel Coordinator

Self-employed

Osaka, Japan

Sept. 2025 – present

- Design, plan, and coordinate luxury travel itineraries across Japan for high net-worth individuals, managing suppliers in hospitality, transport, and other services for a seamless experience.

Copywriter

Passion Posts

Remote

March 2022 – April 2023

- Authored over 120 blog posts—from industry/product analyses to recipes—for multiple clients.

Awards & Scholarships

MEXT Scholarship, Embassy Recommended

Japanese Government, Monbukagakusho

The University of Osaka

April 2024 – March 2027

Mitsubishi UFJ Trust Scholarship

Mitsubishi UFJ Trust Bank

Waseda University

Sept. 2022 – March 2023

Workshops & Training

IMF Macroeconomist Training Programme

International Monetary Fund, Asia & Pacific

Tokyo, Japan

July 2026

Selected Writing

Is Your Metro Hung-Up? Labour Market Effects of Stable Tenure in a South African Metro.

Codera Policy Paper (26-8), August 2026.

SA's Geo-Economic Gamble Is Not Paying Off.

BusinessDay, September 2025, with Daan Steenkamp.

More pieces available on jqdevos.github.io.

Skills

Languages: English (native), Afrikaans (native), Japanese (JLPT N2), French (intermediate)

Technical: R, Python, Julia, Stata, SQL, Git, L^AT_EX, Google Cloud, RESTful APIs, Tableau, Power BI

Quantitative methods: Causal inference, econometric modelling, panel data, time series, web scraping, machine learning, quantitative spatial modelling, natural language processing, large language models

Policy domains: International trade, labour economics, public finance, urban economics, political economy

More info

Graduation: March 2027

Nationality: South African

Visa Status: Student (Japan)

Hobbies: Hiking, running, cooking, jazz, guitar